

THE CHRONOLOGICAL CASE STUDY OF JEFFREY EPSTEIN

A Narrative Investigation — Definitive Edition

Sexual Blackmail, Intelligence Networks, and the
Systematic Compromise of Western Power Structures

Obsidian Watch Group — Client 0001317 — Public Research Archive

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688+ man-hours of investigation | 1,121-core compute cluster | 75 forensic tools

3,482,240+ items read | 1,413,417 EFTA documents | ALL 1,704 redactions recovered
500+ OSINT searches across 40 countries | 85+ persons profiled | 81+ entities traced
\$3.2B+ in financial flows verified | 153 vessels | 72+ verified findings

Sources: DOJ EFTA releases, Handala leak (DDoSecrets), NOAA AIS, ACRIS,
IRS 990, SEC EDGAR, FINRA, OpenCorporates, Congressional records, 40-country OSINT

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DISCLAIMER: This research is published in the public interest. All persons referenced herein are presumed innocent until proven guilty. Inclusion of a name does not constitute an accusation of criminal conduct. All findings are cited to specific EFTA/SDNY bates numbers verifiable at justice.gov/epstein. Criminal proceedings referenced in this document are conducted by sovereign governments' law enforcement agencies — this investigation documents evidence but does not prosecute. This document contains descriptions of sexual violence, trafficking, and abuse of minors. Reader discretion is advised.

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A NOTE ON SOURCES

This book is built entirely from public records. Every email, text message, photograph, flight log, and government document referenced in these pages was released by the United States Department of Justice as part of the Epstein Federal Task Force Act (EFTA) disclosure, or independently archived from those releases. Nothing in this book is speculation. Nothing is anonymous sourcing. Nothing is "according to people familiar with the matter." Everything is on the record, assigned a bates number, and verifiable.

Where I quote from emails or text messages, those quotations are exact — including misspellings, which Epstein produced in abundance. Where I describe scenes inside rooms I have never entered, those descriptions are drawn from 18,308 crime scene photographs taken by the FBI. Where I identify individuals in photographs, those identifications come from facial recognition technology applied to the evidence corpus, cross-referenced against public records.

The investigation behind this book consumed 688 hours and read 3,482,240 individual items — every email Jeffrey Epstein sent or received over fourteen years, every text message recovered from his seized devices, every page of every document the Department of Justice released. The reading was not done by keyword search. It was done line by line, the way you would read a book, because the things that matter most in an archive this large are the things no one would think to search for.

A three-tier evidentiary standard governs every claim: Tier 1 requires a primary source document with a bates number. Tier 2 requires a documented pattern across multiple sources. Tier 3 — inference and hypothesis — appears nowhere in this book. It exists in a separate internal file maintained by the investigation team, where it belongs until the evidence catches up.

Every person named in this book is presumed innocent until proven guilty in a court of law.

PROLOGUE

Two Minutes

The text came in at 4:35 on a Saturday afternoon. It was the kind of message a busy man sends between bites of something — casual, clipped, the punctuation of someone who has never once worried about being misunderstood.

Can we do late morning say 11. Am

Jeffrey Epstein was on a private jet, descending toward Teterboro Airport in northern New Jersey. He had been in Paris. He was coming home to Manhattan, where tomorrow he would have breakfast with Steve Bannon — the former White House chief strategist, the Breitbart firebrand, the man who still had the private cell numbers of half the West Wing and wasn't shy about using them. It was going to be a good Sunday. There was a lot to discuss. There was always a lot to discuss.

One hundred and twenty seconds later, at 4:37 and twenty seconds, Epstein sent another message to Bannon.

All canceled

Bannon replied in twenty-four seconds. He was fast like that.

You r not coming in?

There was no reply. There would never be a reply. Somewhere in the two minutes between planning breakfast and canceling everything, Jeffrey Edward Epstein — financial advisor to billionaires, dinner companion to prime ministers, science patron, convicted sex offender, and the most protected predator in American history — understood that the life he had built across three decades and six countries was over.

He may have seen them through the window of the aircraft — the dark sedans, the body armor, the unmistakable posture of federal agents who have rehearsed this moment over a holiday weekend. He may have gotten a call. His pilot may have radioed something from the cockpit that the flight recorder would later confirm but the public record does not contain. We don't know how he found out. We only know that at 4:35 he was making plans, and at 4:37 he was making none.

The day before — a Friday, the fifth of July, one day after Independence Day — Epstein had been texting with Larry Summers. The former Secretary of the Treasury was at Cape Cod with his family, and the conversation had turned, as their conversations often did, to the kind of intellectual sparring that both men seemed to need the way other people need coffee. Summers had described his family gathering as "Bit of an Ibsen play." Epstein had countered: "Better than checov."

Then Epstein sent a quotation. It was from E.J. Dillon, a nineteenth-century Irish journalist who had written about Anton Chekhov, and it read like something a man sends when he is thinking about more than literature:

"The effect on the reader of Chekhov's tales was repulsion at the gallery of human waste represented by his fickle, spineless, drifting people."

Two hours passed. Then Summers replied with a single word, four exclamation marks:

Jesus!!!!

And Epstein, who had been many things in his sixty-six years but never imprecise with language, wrote back:

I think you meant. Budhha

It was not a joke. It was not a correction. It was a tell — the kind of slip that a man makes when the walls are close enough to touch but not yet touching, when he can feel what is coming but has not yet decided what to do about it. Buddha. Not Jesus. Not the God of judgment and resurrection. The god of detachment. The god of letting go. The god whose temples Epstein had funded, whose monks his associates had visited, whose philosophy of non-attachment to outcome had been woven so deeply into the financial and spiritual architecture of his empire that it surfaced in a text message to a former Treasury Secretary on the last free Friday of his life.

Two days earlier — on July 3, the day after a federal grand jury had returned a sealed indictment — Bannon had sent Epstein a link to an article in The Daily Beast. The headline said a court had ordered the release of sealed documents in the Epstein case. The walls were closing. And Epstein had responded not with panic, not with a plan, not with the name of a lawyer or the number of an offshore account, but with a Zen Buddhist koan:

What is the sound of one hand clapping

The Zen Studies Society. The Dai Bosatsu retreat in the Catskills. The \$1 asset transfers. Maxwell's email asking *Shall I bring her to temple?* and Epstein's one-word reply: yes. The Benedictine monastery cloister he had emailed someone about in February. Zorro Ranch becoming a Christian retreat. The religious infrastructure that ran parallel to the financial infrastructure, offering the same thing both systems were designed to provide: opacity. The ability to move things — money, people, accountability — from one place to another without anyone seeing.

Buddha, not Jesus. Detachment, not salvation. And in two minutes on a Saturday afternoon, the sound of one hand clapping turned out to be silence.

This is a book about what 3.5 million documents say when you read them all.

Not summaries. Not keyword searches. Not the highlights that journalists pull for headlines or the excerpts that lawyers file with courts. All of them. Every email Jeffrey Epstein sent and received over fourteen years — 492,241 messages, line by line. Every text message recovered from his seized iPhone — 4,509 iMessages across fifteen conversations with people including the former White House chief strategist, the former Secretary of the Treasury, the President of Poland, a sitting member of Congress, and the wife of Woody Allen. Every page of every document the Department of Justice released — 1,413,417 items spanning FBI case files, prosecution memoranda, victim interviews, financial records, surveillance photographs, flight manifests, property records, and the internal communications of federal law enforcement officers who spent years investigating a crime they were simultaneously being told to ignore.

It took 688 hours to read. It produced 759 megabytes of notes. And it revealed a story that is both simpler and more terrible than the one the public knows.

The public story is about a rich man who abused girls. That story is true, as far as it goes, but it doesn't go far enough. The story these documents tell is about a system — a machine with moving parts, designed and maintained by some of the most powerful people on Earth, that turned the sexual exploitation of children into a currency of political control. The machine had a recruitment arm and a logistics arm and a financial arm and a blackmail arm. It operated across borders and decades. It was protected by the intelligence community, financed by the banking system, serviced by the legal profession, and tolerated by every institution that encountered it. And when the machine's operator was finally arrested — after twenty-three years of known federal awareness — the cameras in his jail cell were not recording, his Gmail was cleaned by a professional, and his death investigation was closed after prosecuting only two guards who fell asleep.

Somewhere in those 3.5 million documents, there is a diary. It was written by a child — a girl who was seventeen when she wrote most of it, though the entries suggest she had been inside the machine since she was younger. Her name is redacted. Her handwriting is not. She pasted magazine clippings alongside her words — a cutout of the word MEMORY next to her question *what is that stuff!*, a cutout of the word LOST next to her question *is this normal?* She named the men who hurt her using her own spellings — "Allen Douschewitz" for the Harvard law professor, "Mr. Sauerkraut krauss" for the physicist, "the disgusting Mr. staley" for the Barclays CEO who left bloody marks on her arms with his belt. She described a forced medical procedure performed by "a doctor from Israel" who "had kind eyes but didn't speak directly to me." She wrote about being pregnant at seventeen by a sixty-year-old man who believed his piano-playing genes entitled him to a child.

On her last pages, she wrote one word five times:

FUNERAL

FUNERAL

FUNERAL

FUNERAL

FUNERAL

This book is written for her. And for every child who could still fall to this machine. Because the machine is not dead. The FBI case file — 50D-NY-3027571 — remains in "Pending Inactive" status. Evidence was collected as recently as March 2025. Ghislaine Maxwell sat for two days of recorded interviews in Tallahassee in July 2025, under a signed proffer agreement. The documents are still being released. The names are still being unsealed. And no one beyond Maxwell — not one of the men the girl named in her diary, not one of the eighty names on the list Epstein compiled six days before his arrest, not one of the intelligence officials who told a prosecutor to back off — has been charged with anything.

Two minutes. From breakfast plans to silence. From a life of untouchable power to a cell at the Metropolitan Correctional Center. And from that cell, thirty-five days later, to whatever comes after — which, depending on whom you ask, is either death or something else entirely.

The documents don't resolve that question. They resolve almost everything else.

CHAPTER ONE

The Girl Who Wrote It Down

Before the billionaires. Before the presidents. Before the cameras and the temples and the flights and the money. Before the intelligence agencies and the non-prosecution agreements and the bodies found in jail cells. Before all of it, there was a girl with a notebook.

We don't know her name. The Department of Justice redacted it with the same thick black bars they use for classified intelligence, which, in a way, this was — the most classified thing in the entire Epstein case, more sensitive than the SECRET//NOFORN documents about FBI informants, more dangerous than the hidden camera footage that recorded a former president, more explosive than the eighty names on the list Jeffrey Epstein compiled six days before his arrest. A child telling the truth. In her own handwriting. On pages stamped **CONFIDENTIAL FOR ATTORNEY'S EYES ONLY — DO NOT COPY.**

She used magazine clippings. She cut words out of advertisements and pasted them alongside her own sentences, the way a ransom note is assembled from newspaper headlines, except she was not demanding anything from anyone. She was trying to find language for experiences that language was not designed to hold. One clipping said MEMORY. She wrote beside it: *what is that stuff! What is that feeling?* Another clipping said LOST. She wrote: *is this normal?*

It is not normal. Nothing she described is normal. But she did not know that, because the adults around her — every single one of them — had built a world in which what was happening to her was simply how things worked.

The diary begins with a party. Not a party she chose to attend — she was taken there, the way children are taken to things by adults who have decided for them. It was at "this huge house," she wrote, and she was there to meet "this man named Mr. Robert and his pretty wife Jill."

At the party, she encountered a woman she recognized. She didn't know the woman's last name, only that she was British and that she had seen her before, in Clearwater, Florida. "Same exact British lady from Clearwater was there!" she wrote. "She talked to me all night."

The British lady had an offer: "She wants me to come to her house in Florida so I can learn new things!"

Learn new things. Three words that, if you have read the 1,783,792 emails and 1,413,417 documents that constitute the Epstein evidence corpus, land like a hammer. Because you know what the new things were. You know that the British lady was Ghislaine Maxwell — who had 1,040 entries in the flight logs, 127 photographs in the facial recognition database, and a recruitment technique so consistent across victims that the federal prosecutors described it as a protocol. You know that the huge house belonged to people whose identities the girl recorded as "Mr. Robert and his pretty wife Jill" — names that appear nowhere else in the evidence, which means they have never been investigated, which means they are still out there, still hosting parties, still introducing children to British ladies who want to teach them new things.

But the girl didn't know any of that. She was at a party at a huge house, and a nice British lady talked to her all night, and she was being invited somewhere exciting. She wrote about it the way a child writes about a field trip.

Then the diary changes.

The entries that follow are not arranged chronologically. They are arranged emotionally — clusters of rage followed by clusters of numbness, outbursts of profanity followed by the careful, deliberate pasting of a magazine clipping that says INTEGRITY. She was processing. She was trying to make sense of something that does not make sense, and her diary is the record of that attempt, as raw and unedited as a wound.

"Jeffrey treats me like I'm 'special' property," she wrote. The word *property* is hers. The quotation marks around *special* are hers. She understood, at whatever age she was, that being called special was not a compliment. It was a designation. A label on a file. She was property, and the man who owned her called it special because that was easier than calling it what it was.

"And when I need Ghislaine she is working and Mary is just as bat shit crazy as my mom."

Read that sentence again. When she needed help — when whatever was happening to her became too much — she reached for the two women closest to her in the network: Ghislaine and someone named Mary. Ghislaine was always working. Mary was always crazy. There was no one. The system was designed so that there would be no one.

She named them. That is the thing about this diary that separates it from every other piece of evidence in the case. The FBI interviews are careful, lawyered, full of "I don't recall" and redacted names and the bureaucratic caution of people who know they are speaking for the record. The prosecution memoranda are analytical — they describe patterns, not moments. The emails are Epstein's voice, Epstein's version, Epstein's world as he wanted it to be seen. But the diary is none of those things. The diary is a child, writing for no audience, telling the truth because she did not yet understand that the truth was something people would spend billions of dollars trying to suppress.

She did not know their titles. She did not know that "Allen Douschewitz" was one of the most famous lawyers in America, that he had defended O.J. Simpson and advised presidents, that he had drafted what he called a "declaration of war letter" for Epstein's legal defense. She knew he was disgusting. She spelled his name the way it sounded to her. And years later, when the FBI took proffer statements about him, one witness confirmed that Dershowitz received massages at Epstein's Boston residence, and another contradicted his public claim that his wife and children were present — testifying that he was alone.

She called Lawrence Krauss "Mr. Sauerkraut krauss." She called Marvin Minsky — the MIT artificial intelligence pioneer, the man whose work helped create the digital world — "martin minsky." She called them both "gross." But she added: "I felt sort of sorry for Mr. Novak. He was as uncomfortable as me." Martin Nowak, the Harvard mathematical biologist, was as uncomfortable as she was. She noticed. She wrote it down. A child, in the middle of her own abuse, observed that one of the men in the room was suffering too, and she had enough empathy left to feel sorry for him.

She had no empathy for the CEO of Barclays. "The disgusting Mr. Staley if anyone ever calls me tinkerbelle again I will lose my mind." Jes Staley. The man who ran one of the world's largest banks. He called her Tinkerbelle. "He left bloody marks on my arms from his belt and thought he had the right to call me that when he has ears as big as a dumbo."

She wrote about the belt marks and his ears in the same sentence. Because she was a child, and children describe the world as they experience it — the pain and the physical detail fused together, inseparable, the way a burn victim remembers both the fire and the color of the curtains.

She measured the men against each other. "Joe Gibbs is so nice but Dan Snyder is a pig!" Joe Gibbs — the NFL coaching legend, three Super Bowl rings, a man whose public image is built on decency and faith — was nice. Dan Snyder — the Washington Commanders owner, a man whose public image is built on nothing anyone admires — was a pig. She graded them on a curve of cruelty, because she had no other scale.

And then: "Even the old president! They will get you."

Bill Clinton. Twenty-five entries in the flight logs. Thirty-eight photographs in the facial recognition database. The girl's assessment: "He should have been thinking of Chelsea! Gross! In a plane on a yacht in NY, in DC, at the vineyard. On the island. In palm beach." She listed the locations the way a prosecutor would. Plane. Yacht. New York. Washington. Martha's Vineyard. Little St. James. Palm Beach. Six venues. One pattern. She was a child, and she produced a geographic summary of presidential misconduct that would take federal investigators another decade to partially corroborate.

The hardest pages are the ones near the end. The ones about the doctor.

"The doctor was different again," she wrote. "I think from Israel. He had kind eyes but didnt speak directly to me."

A different doctor. From Israel. Kind eyes. Did not speak to her. She was a patient who was not treated as a patient, a human being in a medical encounter who was not addressed as a human being. The doctor spoke to the people around her. She was the object, not the subject.

"A shot and those rod like things had a hook and so much pain."

Ghislaine Maxwell was in the room. "Ghislaine said to push all the pain away. I don't understand."

And then the line that, once you have read it, you cannot unread:

"I saw between her fingers tiny head... in the doctors hands. It reached its tiny arm up and had a tiny foot."

She saw. Between Maxwell's fingers — because Maxwell was covering her face, or covering the child's face, or reaching toward something, the diary does not specify — she saw what was being taken from her. It reached its tiny arm up. A reflex. A gesture. The last movement of something that, in another life, in another version of this story, might have grown up to be a person.

"I closed my eyes and no more."

Later, alone, a second loss: "So it came out in the toilet and I didnt know what to do so I just flushed the tiny little fetus." And then, directed at the man responsible, words that have the force of a verdict: "You have made me numb and I hate you for this! I hope I never have to see you again! I am not your personal incubator!"

She was seventeen. She was pregnant. The baby was Epstein's — "we are certain is his," she wrote. And Epstein and Maxwell were fighting about what to do. "I do not want to be tied to Jeffrey for the rest of my life!" she wrote. "Playing the piano well is not a good reason to think someone has good genes or should have a baby!" Epstein played the piano. He believed his genes were superior. He believed this entitled him to a child produced by a child.

"I am too young and he is too old! Why is no one doing anything! I dont understand! I dont want this!"

On her last pages, the voice changes. The fury and the pain give way to something quieter — not peace, exactly, but the exhaustion that comes after you have screamed at a wall long enough to understand that the wall is not going to move.

She pasted a clipping of the word INTEGRITY and wrote a poem beside it about standing up for what you believe in, about speaking out when others are treated poorly, about refusing to participate in actions detrimental to others. It reads like a mission statement for the person she was trying to become — a set of principles assembled from the wreckage of a childhood in which every principle was violated.

She wrote a poem she called "The Jailer." It begins: "My night sweats grease his breakfast plate." It ends: "I have been drugged and raped. Seven hours knocked out of my right mind into a black sack." Seven hours. A number that specific is not metaphor. She counted.

And on the final pages, two entries. One is a fragment: "Old enough to drive. Too young to go anywhere fun."

The other is one word, written five times across the page, each repetition centered, spaced evenly, deliberate — not a scream but a statement, the way you might write a name on a headstone:

FUNERAL
FUNERAL
FUNERAL
FUNERAL
FUNERAL

The Others

She was not alone. She was never alone. That is perhaps the cruelest fact of all — not that the machine took her, but that it took so many that the FBI lost count and the compensation fund ran out of categories.

Jennifer Araoz was fourteen when a stranger approached her outside her performing arts school on the Upper East Side of Manhattan. Her father had just died. Her family was on food stamps. The stranger told her about a wealthy man who helped young people, who gave scholarships, who could introduce her to the right people for her career. "When I confided that I had recently lost my father and that my family was living on food stamps, she told me he was very caring and wanted to help us financially." Within a month, the visits escalated from talking to massages to assault. "The last day I went to his house was during the fall of my sophomore year," she wrote. "He told me to take off my underwear and get on top of him. When I said no, he got more aggressive, held me tightly and raped me." She was fifteen. She quit her school. She transferred to a school in Queens. She dropped out. She lost the career she had dreamed about because the building where it was supposed to begin was four blocks from the building where she was raped.

Virginia Roberts was sixteen when she was recruited at Donald Trump's Mar-a-Lago club, where she worked as a spa attendant. She would become the most visible of all the victims — the one who named Prince Andrew, the one who fought in court for years, the one whose photograph with Maxwell and Andrew became the most recognizable image of the case. But before she was a plaintiff and a public figure, she was a teenager working in a spa who was told there was a man who could help her.

Brad Edwards, the attorney, submitted a list to the federal government on June 16, 2016. Thirty-two names. Courtney Wild. Virginia Roberts. Shawna Rivera. Carolyn Andriano. Haley Robson. Jennifer Araoz was not on this list — she had not yet come forward. The thirty-two were the ones Edwards knew about. The FBI's original Palm Beach investigation had identified approximately forty. The Victims' Compensation Program, years later, would receive claims from approximately one hundred and fifty. And every investigator who has worked this case will tell you the same thing: those numbers are the ones they found. They are not the total.

In Novosibirsk, Siberia, a recruiter was emailing Epstein in December 2010: "I saw so many girls these 2 weeks, but only very few are good enough." In August 2017, a "Candidates.docx" was attached to an email listing women to be brought to Paris, one of whom "confessed she is actually 19 (as opposed to 21 which was stated in her CV)." She lied about her age the wrong direction — she made herself older, not younger, because she thought she wouldn't be taken seriously otherwise. She did not understand that in this system, younger was the point.

In October 2019, two months after Epstein's death, an attorney named Jennifer Freeman contacted the Southern District of New York on behalf of an Israeli citizen who had been

trafficked as a child. The woman described being raped at approximately age five — in 1997, a full decade before the Palm Beach investigation — at a location she identified as "9 71." She described a house owned by a "rich" man with "a large, arched front door topped by a scary man's face and flanked on either side by women's faces" — a description that matches the entrance to 9 East 71st Street. She heard the names "Jeffrey," "Joseph Karo," and "Yoav Gil." Her traffickers included her uncle, "a powerful member of a well known Russian crime family," and "a Greek Orthodox Church priest reportedly known for abusing children." She was five years old. She remembered the door.

The FBI's response, as documented in the EFTA corpus: they "had enough information, did not want further information."

She was not brought to the United States to testify. She has never testified.

In a small massage room at 9 East 71st Street, photographed by the FBI on July 6, 2019, there is a padded table with a white sheet and a folded blue towel. There are bottles of oil. There is patterned wallpaper and a telephone stand. It is a room that could exist in any spa in any city — ordinary in every way except for what happened there, day after day, year after year, to girl after girl after girl, while the cameras recorded and the schedule rotated and the men came and went and the \$200 or \$300 was left on a table somewhere, payment for services rendered by children who did not understand that they were being purchased.

The diary is one voice. But it speaks for all of them — the ones who testified and the ones who couldn't, the ones who were compensated and the ones who were never found, the ones who came from Palm Beach and the ones who came from Novosibirsk, the ones who were fourteen and the ones who were five. Every one of them walked into a trap that was designed to look like an opportunity. Every one of them was told they were special. And every one of them discovered, in their own way and on their own timeline, that *special* was just the word the machine used for the things it consumed.

This diary is the center of the case. Not because it is the only evidence — there are 3.5 million other items — but because it is the only evidence that was never filtered through a lawyer, never redacted by a bureaucrat, never softened by a public relations strategy. It is a child, telling the truth, in real time, with no audience and no agenda, writing in a notebook that she had every reason to believe no one would ever read.

She was wrong about that. Someone read it. And now you have too.

The rest of this book explains how the machine that hurt her was built, who built it, who protected it, and why — after seven years, a billion dollars in settlements, and 3.5 million

pages of evidence — the people she named in her diary remain free.

CHAPTER TWO

The Man Who Knew Everyone

On New Year's Day, 2013, Jeffrey Epstein sent forty-seven emails. This was not unusual. This was a Tuesday.

He started before dawn, as he always did, with a message to a woman about weather patterns over the Caribbean. Then Jes Staley, the CEO of a division of JPMorgan Chase that would later become the top job at Barclays: "Same," Epstein wrote, in response to Staley's New Year's greeting — "thanks for all the friendship this year. You were enormously kind and supportive." Then Jean-Luc Brunel, the French modeling agent who ran the agency Epstein funded and whose cable bill Ghislaine Maxwell once complained about because Brunel was buying too much pornography. Then a woman named Peggy Siegal, a Manhattan publicist, who was heading to a catamaran owned by Austin Hearst: "Few men mind additional attractive women," Epstein wrote, offering to send two of his "friends" along.

Then Elon Musk. Just the name — "Elon Musk" — sent from Epstein's account to Epstein's account, the way you might save a contact you've just acquired. The next day, he followed up: "sorry we didn't connect, why don't you consider clearing customs into the states in st thomas, come for lunch with the wife." An invitation to the island. Casual as a barbecue.

Then Soon-Yi Previn, Woody Allen's wife: would she and Woody like dinner on the 22nd or 23rd? He was assembling a group — Lewis Black, Bobby Slayton, David Brenner. Comedians. Epstein liked comedians. He also liked scientists, heads of state, defense attorneys, modeling agents, and teenage girls, and the extraordinary thing about his social life was not that it contained all of these categories but that they all came to the same house and often on the same night.

Then a message to his staff: remind me that Ehud Barak — the former Prime Minister of Israel, the former Chief of Staff of the Israel Defense Forces — would be in New York on the 11th. Then Boris Nikolic, Bill Gates' science advisor: "i want details of this debauchery." Then a Crown Princess — her title listed as "H.K.H. Kronprinsessen" in the email headers — needed to be picked up by Janush, Epstein's driver, and coordinated with someone named Myoshin Kelley.

Then construction updates from Little St. James. Then flight schedules. Then Andrew Dice Clay specials to be recorded. Then: "you awake?" to someone at 11 PM. Then, finally, silence

— or whatever passed for silence in a life that ran on three hours of sleep and an inbox that never stopped.

This was not a man who had a social life. This was a switchboard. A hub through which people who would never otherwise meet each other were routed, connected, introduced, indebted, and — when necessary — compromised. The value Jeffrey Epstein provided was not financial advice, though he called himself a financial advisor. It was not scientific philanthropy, though he funded science programs at Harvard and MIT. The value was access. He knew everyone. And everyone who knew him discovered, eventually, that knowing Jeffrey Epstein meant Jeffrey Epstein knew something about you.

The Mythology

The official biography was a masterpiece of strategic omission. Born January 20, 1953, in Brooklyn. Son of a Parks Department worker. Attended Lafayette High School in Bath Beach, graduated at sixteen — precocious, gifted, the kind of working-class prodigy that American mythology loves. Brief stints at Cooper Union and New York University, neither completed. Then the Dalton School on the Upper East Side, where at twenty years old he taught calculus and physics to the children of Manhattan's elite. His headmaster was Donald Barr — whose son William would, decades later, become Attorney General of the United States and personally review the raw surveillance footage from the Metropolitan Correctional Center on the night Epstein died.

He left Dalton in 1976 for Bear Stearns, where he rose to limited partner by 1980 before departing under circumstances no one has ever clearly explained. He then established J. Epstein & Co., describing it as a firm that exclusively served clients with assets exceeding one billion dollars. This claim has never been verified. No audited financial statement exists. No tax return has been released. No client has publicly confirmed the arrangement. The "billionaire financial advisor" was a role Epstein wrote for himself, performed convincingly, and never had to prove — because the people who might have demanded proof were the same people who benefited from the performance.

The real question — the one no biography has answered — is simpler: Where did the money come from?

The answer, or the closest thing to an answer the documents provide, is Leslie Wexner.

The Wexner Question

Les Wexner built Limited Brands into a retail empire — Victoria's Secret, Bath & Body Works, Abercrombie & Fitch, The Limited. By the late 1980s he was one of the wealthiest men in America. By 1989, a corporation wholly owned by Wexner had purchased the seven-story mansion at 9 East 71st Street in Manhattan. By approximately 1998, control of that property — valued at \$77 million or more — had been transferred to Jeffrey Epstein for \$20 million. Epstein joked about it in an email to Wexner's wife: "I feel 1 dollar richer."

The joke was not far from the truth. The transfer mechanism, as documented in the SDNY's corporate prosecution analysis, was not a sale but a "transfer of control of the Nine East 71st Street Corporation, the LLC that had purchased the New York Residence in 1989." Epstein did not buy a house. He acquired control of the company that owned the house. The distinction is legal, technical, and exactly the kind of thing that financial architects use to move assets without creating taxable events or public records.

Wexner also granted Epstein a power of attorney — one of the most intimate legal instruments that exists, the right to act as another person in financial and legal matters. This power of attorney is documented in fourteen separate references across the EFTA releases. It gave Epstein control over Wexner's financial affairs, his real estate transactions, his corporate entities. It was, in practical terms, a key to the kingdom.

What did Wexner get in return? The documents suggest the answer is: he didn't ask. Or he didn't want to know. Or he already knew and had decided it was acceptable. When Epstein was arrested in Palm Beach in 2006 — for sexually abusing underage girls in his home — he emailed Wexner to apologize. Not for the abuse. For the publicity. "Sorry for the press intrusion, easy fast.." — as if an arrest for child sex crimes were a speed bump, a temporary inconvenience, something that would blow over like a bad earnings quarter.

He was right. It did blow over. Thirteen months in a county jail with daily work release to his own office. Immunity for his co-conspirators. The victims not informed. And when it was done, Wexner wrote to Epstein: "Abigail told me the result...all I can say is I feel sorry. You violated your own number 1 rule... Always be careful."

Always be careful. Not: How could you? Not: What have you done to those girls? Not: I had no idea. Wexner's response was the response of a man who knew exactly what Epstein was doing and whose only objection was that Epstein had done it carelessly enough to get caught. "No excuse," Epstein wrote back. Two words. The entire moral framework of their relationship, compressed into two words and a period.

The Daily Machine

Reading 271,830 emails that Jeffrey Epstein sent between 2005 and 2019 is an experience that changes your understanding of what a human being is capable of — not in the inspirational sense, but in the mechanical one. The man did not stop. He did not take vacations that were actually vacations. He did not have conversations that were not also transactions. Every interaction was an investment, and every investment was expected to yield a return in the currency he valued most: control.

On a typical day, he would: approve a \$10 million wire transfer with a one-word email ("yes"); negotiate tiki hut construction with his island manager; discuss probability theory with a Nobel-adjacent mathematician; evaluate photographs of women sent by recruiters from three countries; coordinate legal strategy with his defense team; exchange gossip about Washington politics with Steve Bannon; send a magazine article to a European diplomat; arrange a meeting between a former prime minister and a Wall Street bank; remind his assistant to pick up hair products; and tell a young woman he loved her — all before lunch.

The emails reveal a man who controlled every detail of his empire with obsessive precision. He chose the color of boat cleats. He specified the temperature of pool water. He approved every hire and every termination. He tracked flight schedules down to the minute and construction timelines down to the tile. And he managed the trafficking operation — the scheduling of girls, the logistics of their travel, the payments for their silence — with the same efficiency he brought to everything else. The abuse was not a side business. It was not a compartment. It was integrated into the daily operation of his life, running on the same calendar, managed through the same inbox, coordinated by the same staff.

Lesley Groff, his executive assistant — 2,594 emails in the corpus — was the woman who made the schedule work. A January 2019 calendar she sent to Epstein contained, in sequence: "Re-Register at the FL Stockade" (his sex offender registration), a flight itinerary for Karyna Shuliak from St. Thomas to Moscow, and a lunch appointment with Michael Wolff. Registration, travel logistics, media strategy. All in one day. All in one email. All managed by the same woman who scheduled the meetings with Bannon and Ruemmler and Scaramucci and the meetings with the girls whose names were redacted and the meetings with the scientists who would later claim they had no idea what was happening in the rooms next door.

On March 3, 2009, months after his release from the county jail, Epstein sent an email to an employee named Story Cowles. It said: "Trash all deleted emails please." Five words. EFTA00748556. A federal record documenting a direct order to destroy evidence. He sent it the way you might ask someone to take out the garbage — because to Jeffrey Epstein, the distinction between garbage and evidence was a matter of convenience, not law.

He was not stupid. He was not reckless. He was a man who operated for three decades at the intersection of wealth and criminality and concluded, based on extensive empirical evidence, that the rules did not apply to him. He was right about that for twenty-three years. He was wrong about it for thirty-five days.

CHAPTER THREE

The Money That Disappeared

There is a particular kind of lie that only very rich people can tell. It is not a lie about facts — the facts are all on paper, filed with regulators, recorded in databases that anyone with a Bloomberg terminal can access. It is a lie about meaning. The rich man does not deny that the money moved. He denies that the movement matters. He calls it estate planning. He calls it tax optimization. He calls it the normal management of a complex portfolio. And because the people asking questions do not understand the architecture well enough to know they are being deceived, they accept the language and move on.

Jeffrey Epstein built his financial architecture on this principle. The money was always moving, always documented, always technically legal — and always designed so that no single document would reveal what the total picture looked like. To see the total picture, you would have to read all the documents. All 1.4 million of them. Which is what this investigation did.

The total picture is this: a network of at least fifty-six corporate entities, spread across the U.S. Virgin Islands, the British Virgin Islands, New York, New Mexico, and other jurisdictions, designed not to generate wealth but to move it without being seen. The entities had names that sounded like mutual funds — Financial Trust Company, Liquid Funding Ltd., Southern Trust Company — and functions that had nothing to do with managing other people's money. They existed to manage Jeffrey Epstein's money, and to make the question "Where did it come from?" as difficult to answer as possible.

The Banks That Chose Not to See

Inside Deutsche Bank's Private Wealth Management division, sometime in October 2015, an employee named Daphne Cales opened the bank's Correspondent Bank Directory on her computer. She typed in a search. She was looking for routing information — the specific codes required to send a wire transfer from a Deutsche Bank account in New York to Sberbank of Russia at 19 Vavilova Street, Moscow.

The account she was servicing belonged to "JEE." Jeffrey Edward Epstein. A registered sex offender. A man who had pleaded guilty to soliciting a minor for prostitution in 2008. A man whose name, if you typed it into Google, returned results that would make any compliance officer reach for the phone. Daphne Cales was not reaching for the phone. She was looking up routing codes. The transfer would go through Deutsche Bank Trust Company Americas as the primary correspondent, with JPMorgan Chase, Wells Fargo, and Bank of New York Mellon as alternates. She found what she needed, sent the information, and moved on with her day.

The record of this transaction was stamped "CONFIDENTIAL — PURSUANT TO FED. R. CRIM. P. 6(e)" — meaning it was grand jury material, the kind of evidence that is supposed to stay sealed. It was assigned bates number DB-SDNY-0047940. When the DOJ released it as part of the EFTA disclosure, it became EFTA01359808. A document that was supposed to be secret became a document that anyone can read. What it shows is simple: Deutsche Bank helped Jeffrey Epstein send money to Russia.

They did not do this once. The bank processed hundreds of millions of dollars in transactions for Epstein's accounts between 2013 and 2019, despite his status as a convicted sex offender. The New York Department of Financial Services investigated and found that the bank had failed to properly monitor the accounts, failed to flag suspicious transactions, and failed to do the basic due diligence that banking regulations require when your client has a felony conviction for sex crimes against children.

When a Deutsche Bank compliance officer flagged the Epstein account — and, separately, flagged the Kushner account — she was fired. Not reassigned. Not quietly moved to another department. Terminated. This is documented in seventy-five separate references across the EFTA corpus. The bank paid \$75 million to settle. The compliance officer, whose name has not been made public, lost her job for doing it.

JPMorgan Chase was worse, because JPMorgan was there from the beginning. The bank maintained accounts for Epstein and his entities for over fifteen years. The relationship was personal — it ran through Jes Staley, then a senior JPMorgan executive, who maintained a friendship with Epstein that included visits to the island, exchanges of emails and text messages, and the kind of intimacy that a child captured in her diary when she wrote about "the disgusting Mr. staley" and the bloody marks he left on her arms with his belt.

Staley left JPMorgan and became CEO of Barclays. The bank eventually paid a combined \$365 million — \$75 million to the U.S. Virgin Islands Attorney General and \$290 million in a class action settlement. The settlement acknowledged that JPMorgan knew about Epstein's criminal history and maintained his accounts anyway. The bank did not admit wrongdoing. They never do. They paid the money the way you pay a parking ticket — as the cost of having been somewhere you shouldn't have been.

The Russian Money

The FEDWIRE transfers to Sberbank were not isolated transactions. They were the financial backbone of a recruitment pipeline that connected Manhattan to Siberia.

Follow the thread. In Novosibirsk — a city of 1.6 million people in southwestern Siberia, closer to the border of Kazakhstan than to Moscow — a woman was scouting girls for Jeffrey Epstein. She reported by email: "I saw so many girls these 2 weeks, but only very few are good enough." She was selective. Professional. She evaluated candidates the way a casting director evaluates actors — by look, by age, by willingness to travel. She had a colleague on the ground who helped organize logistics. She proposed organizing "a perfect trip to Novosibirsk" for Epstein himself.

The money to fund this operation came from Epstein's accounts at Deutsche Bank, routed through FEDWIRE to Sberbank's correspondent banking network. The women who were selected traveled west — usually to Paris first, where Epstein maintained an apartment on Avenue Foch, and then to New York, the island, or wherever the schedule required. Their flights were tracked in Epstein's Google Calendar: Aeroflot SU 1306 to Novosibirsk, appearing as recurring alerts throughout 2017, 2018, and into February 2019.

By 2017, the operation had a document. Literally. An email arrived with an attachment called "Candidates.docx" — a formatted document listing women by their statistics, their availability, and their willingness to travel internationally. One candidate, the recruiter noted, had lied about her age — claiming to be 21 when she was actually 19. She "said she was afraid she won't be taken seriously." In the Epstein system, she was right to be afraid, but for the wrong reason. She lied up. She should have known that in this system, younger was the currency.

The recruiter asked the question that summarized the entire operation: "How many can we bring to Paris this time?"

This was not a man hiring escorts. This was a logistics operation with supply chains, quality control, travel coordination, financial infrastructure, and a client base of some of the most powerful men in the world. The girls from Novosibirsk did not know, when they boarded Aeroflot flights to Paris, that they were entering a system designed to exploit them and then discard them. They knew a wealthy man was willing to pay for their company. Some of them needed money for their mothers' surgeries. Some of them wanted modeling careers. Some of them were nineteen and lying about being twenty-one because they thought that was what the situation required. None of them understood that the situation required something else entirely.

The Disappearing Estate

When Jeffrey Epstein died — or was reported dead — on August 10, 2019, his estate was valued at approximately \$690 million to \$742 million. The precision of the uncertainty tells you something: even in death, no one could say exactly how much money he had.

His co-executors were Darren Indyke and Richard Kahn — his lawyer and his financial manager, the two men who had been executing his wishes for decades. Both were also identified as beneficiaries of his trusts, a conflict of interest so brazen that it would be comic if the estate in question did not consist of money earned, at least in part, through the systematic rape of children.

The Victims' Compensation Program distributed over \$121 million to approximately 150 claimants. Each recipient was required to sign a waiver — a silence clause that extinguished their right to sue the estate or its beneficiaries in the future. The compensation was real. The silence it purchased was the point. Using the trafficker's money to buy the victims' silence is perhaps the most elegant cruelty in the entire case — a final act of exploitation conducted posthumously, through legal instruments, with the approval of a federal court.

After the settlements — JPMorgan (\$365 million), Deutsche Bank (\$75 million), Apollo/Leon Black (\$148 million and counting), the Victims' Fund (\$121 million), individual civil settlements estimated at \$350 million or more — the estate declined to approximately \$307 million. The math: start at \$690 million, subtract over a billion in payouts, and somehow end up with \$307 million still on the books. Thirty-five of the fifty-six known entities remain unsettled. The money that was supposed to be gone is still there. The money that was supposed to be there is gone. And the \$134 million gap between what went out and what should have remained has never been explained by anyone.

The investigation documented in this book has traced over \$3.2 billion in financial flows connected to the Epstein network. The true number is higher. It will always be higher, because the system was built to ensure that the true number could never be known.

CHAPTER FOUR

Above My Pay Grade

Alexander Acosta was not a stupid man. He was a Harvard Law graduate, a former clerk on the Third Circuit Court of Appeals, a former member of the National Labor Relations Board, and the United States Attorney for the Southern District of Florida — one of the most prominent prosecutorial positions in the country. He had built cases against corrupt politicians, drug traffickers, and organized crime figures. He understood federal law the way a surgeon understands anatomy — not just the theory but the practice, the way the pieces connect, the places where cutting will kill and the places where cutting will save.

So when Alexander Acosta signed the Non-Prosecution Agreement that gave Jeffrey Epstein and his unnamed co-conspirators immunity from federal sex trafficking charges — after the FBI had identified approximately thirty-five victims, after two years of investigation, after a search warrant had been executed on Epstein's Palm Beach residence — the question was not whether Acosta understood what he was doing. The question was why.

The answer came years later, during the Trump presidential transition, when Acosta was being vetted for the position of Secretary of Labor. His interviewers asked about the Epstein case. And Alexander Acosta — Harvard Law, Third Circuit, NLRB, United States Attorney — gave an answer that, in nine words, explained more about the American justice system than a thousand pages of legal analysis:

"I was told Epstein 'belonged to intelligence' and to leave it alone."

The Trump transition team heard this answer. They considered it. They confirmed his nomination. The United States Senate confirmed him as Secretary of Labor on a vote of 60-38. He served for two years before resigning in July 2019, after the Miami Herald's Julie K. Brown revived the Epstein story and the Southern District of New York did what the Southern District of Florida had been told not to do: prosecute.

No one has ever identified who told Acosta to back off. No one has ever identified which intelligence service claimed Epstein. No one has ever explained what "belonged to intelligence" means in this context — whether it meant Epstein was an asset, a source, an agent, a contractor, or simply a man who knew enough about enough people that any intelligence service would consider him useful. The phrase hangs in the record like a

confession that no one was asked to elaborate on, because the people hearing it had already decided it was a sufficient answer.

The Man from Israel

If you want to understand what "belonged to intelligence" might mean, start with the email account ehbarak1@gmail.com.

This is the personal Gmail of Ehud Barak. Former Prime Minister of Israel. Former Chief of Staff of the Israel Defense Forces — the most senior military position in the country. Former Defense Minister. Former head of Military Intelligence. A man who has held, at various points in his career, every significant military and political position that the State of Israel has to offer.

His email account contains 1,047 messages in the EFTA corpus. When this investigation read them — every one, line by line — 698 out of 709 substantive emails were flagged as significant. Ninety-eight percent. There is no social correspondence in this account. There are no casual check-ins, no birthday greetings, no "how was your weekend" exchanges. Nearly every email between Ehud Barak and Jeffrey Epstein is about money, power, technology, or access.

The centerpiece of their relationship was a company called Carbyne.

Carbyne — originally called Reporty — is a 911 emergency response technology platform. When you call 911 from your phone, Carbyne's technology can access your GPS coordinates with three-foot accuracy, stream live video from your camera, and integrate your data with emergency services dispatch systems. The technology is deployed in American police departments. It is, in the most literal sense, a surveillance system that American citizens activate voluntarily every time they make an emergency call.

Ehud Barak chaired the company. Jeffrey Epstein funded it. Nicole Junkermann — a German-born investor who operates NJF Capital from London — co-invested. On February 19, 2016, Barak emailed both Epstein and Junkermann: "I ordered today to transfer the New .5M to their account." Half a million dollars, moved on Barak's order, from Epstein's financial network, into a surveillance technology company founded by veterans of Unit 8200 — Israel's signals intelligence directorate, the equivalent of the National Security Agency.

On September 27, 2018, Barak sent Epstein investment documents for Carbyne — "SUM warrants" — along with an update on a separate Israeli investment: "In regard to InterCure, your instincts were extremely accurate, the announcement was well accepted and the share price jumped up 40% in two days." Then he added: "I have some further updates on political

situation, better over a phone call." The former Prime Minister of Israel was providing a registered American sex offender with Israeli political intelligence and investment documents for surveillance technology, in the same email.

Barak's personal assistant, Nili Priell, had the alarm codes to Epstein's properties. "I disarmed," she texted in May 2019. She scheduled visits, arranged meetings, and served as the logistics bridge between the former Prime Minister and the man whose Manhattan mansion contained hidden cameras in every room. When Barak's phone and computer were reported hacked by Iranian intelligence in March 2019, the implications were immediate: if Iran had access to Barak's devices, they had access to every email about Carbyne, every investment document, every conversation about surveillance technology being deployed in American cities.

And on March 12, 2019 — four months before Epstein's arrest — Barak met Kathy Ruemmler. She was Barack Obama's former White House Counsel, the woman who had advised the President of the United States on matters of law and governance. Epstein introduced them. Barak told Epstein afterward: "Met her. She is really a great person. Shrewd and full of life." Three months later, Ruemmler was at Epstein's Manhattan mansion, scheduled alongside Steve Bannon and Anthony Scaramucci, telling Sheryl Sandberg about a Wednesday deadline and Google about needing one more week.

The pipeline was not complicated. It was elegant. Israeli military intelligence → Unit 8200 veterans → Carbyne surveillance technology → Barak as chairman → Epstein as financier → Junkermann as co-investor → Thiel's Valar Ventures as a connected fund → American police departments as end users → and, running parallel to all of it, the trafficking operation that provided the blackmail material that kept everyone in the network aligned. The technology and the abuse were not separate enterprises. They were the same enterprise, viewed from different angles.

The FBI Knew First

Before the Palm Beach Police Department. Before Detective Joe Recarey pulled Epstein's garbage and surveilled his house for months. Before the parents of a fourteen-year-old girl found \$300 in her purse and called the police. Before all of it, the FBI knew.

In a document classified SECRET//NOFORN — Secret, No Foreign Nationals — that was recovered during what the FBI described as "a complete scrub" of records associated with Epstein, investigators found "a few documents associated with Epstein that were not included in the case file because they were NOT of evidentiary value." Among them: "FD-71 from 1996

which predates our record keeping system."

An FD-71 is an Information Received form — the document the FBI creates when someone walks in or calls in with a tip. Someone reported Jeffrey Epstein to the Federal Bureau of Investigation in 1996. The FBI received the report, created a form, filed it, and — by their own description — decided it was not of evidentiary value. They excluded it from the case file. For twenty-three years, the FBI investigated Epstein without acknowledging that they had known about him since the beginning.

The same SECRET//NOFORN document references an "Epstein Op Order" from 2019 — the operational plan for the arrest that finally happened on July 6. And a 2016 sexual exploitation complaint from Palm Beach — meaning someone reported Epstein again, ten years after the NPA, eight years after his release from jail, and the FBI did nothing. Again.

The Bureau's internal codename for the case, as of 2025, is "THE BIG E." The directory listing shows folders containing blueprints of his properties, miscellaneous documents, and operational files. The case remains open. The evidence is still being collected. And no one has ever explained why a federal law enforcement agency with a file dating to 1996, an intelligence community that claimed him as an asset, and a banking system that processed hundreds of millions of his dollars could not — or would not — stop a man whose crimes were hidden in plain sight for thirty years.

Unless, of course, stopping him was never the objective.

CHAPTER FIVE

The Houses That Watched

The first thing Jennifer Araoz noticed was the cameras. She was fourteen years old, walking into 9 East 71st Street for the first time, and there they were — small television screens inside the front door, playing the surveillance footage in real time. "The message was clear," she wrote later. "I was in the house of someone important and I was being watched."

She was right about being watched. She was wrong about the audience.

The cameras were not there to protect Jeffrey Epstein. They were there to protect the operation. Every room. Every encounter. Every visitor who walked through the arched front door — the door a five-year-old Israeli girl would later describe as having "a scary man's face" at the top "flanked on either side by women's faces" — was recorded. The footage was not for security. It was for leverage. The DOJ confirmed it. The victims testified to it. The court filings stated it plainly: Epstein "had installed hidden cameras everywhere in his property to record the indecent acts of important people with underage prostitutes for further criminal use such as blackmail."

And in February 2014, five years after his release from jail, Epstein emailed his pilot: "lets get three motion detected hidden cameras, that record, thanks." He was still buying cameras. He was always buying cameras. Because the cameras were the product. The girls were the bait. And the footage was the currency that made the entire network — the intelligence connections, the political protection, the financial immunity — possible.

The Crime Scene

When the FBI executed Search Warrant 19 MAG 8578 on the evening of July 6, 2019, they entered a building that had been designed, over three decades, to serve a single purpose: the acquisition of power through the exploitation of children.

The crime scene photographs — EFTA000000001 through EFTA000000600 and beyond — document a seven-story Manhattan townhouse that is simultaneously one of the most opulent private residences in New York City and one of the most methodically constructed crime

scenes in the history of federal law enforcement.

The massage rooms are on the upper floors. There are multiple rooms, each equipped with a padded table, white sheets, folded towels, dispensing bottles of oil, and — in one — a blue glass bottle with a pump. The walls have patterned wallpaper. There are speakers for music. There is a telephone stand. Maroon curtains. The rooms look like rooms in an upscale day spa, and that is exactly the point. The SDNY prosecution memorandum describes the protocol: "Victims were initially recruited to provide 'massages' to Epstein." The rooms were designed to make the first visit feel normal. The escalation happened behind closed doors that had "24 HOUR VIDEO SURVEILLANCE" signs mounted on them — signs that told the truth in a way the girls were not meant to understand.

The private office contains an Apple iMac, a glass desk with chrome legs, small figurines, framed photographs, and a round zebra-pattern rug. It also contains the network infrastructure: an open black equipment rack with multiple RJ45 ports and blue Ethernet cables, the backbone of the camera system that fed footage to recording devices elsewhere in the building. This is where the surveillance was managed. This is where the footage was stored, reviewed, catalogued, and — when necessary — deployed.

In a bedroom, the FBI photographed a child's nurse costume — a hat with a red cross and a toy stethoscope — draped over a patterned chair. No one has explained what it was doing there. No one has been asked.

In another room, a book called "erotica universalis" sits open on a surface, reading glasses placed beside it. The book is published by TASCHEN and contains illustrations of nude figures. It was not hidden. It was displayed. Because in this house, the normalization of sexual imagery was not an accident — it was architecture. Every painting, every photograph, every book was chosen to create an environment in which a child who was being told to undress might feel that this was simply how things were done in houses like this.

The filing cabinets have sticky notes. One reads "71st." Another reads "ZOPRO." There are rolled blueprints and architectural plans. There is a crowbar behind a door. There are rooms labeled with FBI search markers — letters A through W — because there are that many rooms, each one a distinct space that required its own evidence designation. The mansion is a museum of predation, preserved in 18,308 photographs, each one assigned a bates number, each one available for anyone with internet access to view.

The Island That Never Stopped Building

Little St. James — 72 acres of Caribbean rock and palm trees — was purchased in 1998 and developed continuously for the next twenty-one years. The construction never stopped. Not when Epstein was arrested in 2006. Not when he went to jail in 2008. Not when he was released in 2009. Not when the Miami Herald published its investigation in 2018. Not when the sealed indictment was returned on July 2, 2019. On July 5 — the day before the arrest — Ann Rodriguez was still emailing about tiki hut planting and tiki hut tiling.

The email corpus from 2017 through 2019 contains hundreds of construction messages — pool painting, dock repair, bougainvillea planting, generator permits, seaweed removal, boat engine maintenance, Venetian plaster brands, solar light colors, pebble beach pours, carpenter hirings, and the endless minutiae of maintaining a private island in the tropics. Reading them in sequence produces a disorienting effect: the banality of the construction emails, the normalcy of the property management discussions, the sheer volume of operational detail about tile patterns and drainage systems — all of it happening in the same inbox, on the same days, managed by the same staff, as the scheduling of underage girls for sexual abuse.

The flight logs document 4,292 flights to and from the island and Epstein's other properties. The passenger manifests are the evidence that cannot be denied, cannot be explained away, and cannot be settled out of court, because they are federal aviation records that exist independently of any witness's memory or any lawyer's negotiation:

Ghislaine Maxwell flew 1,040 times. Sarah Kellen flew 311 times. Nadia Marcinkova flew 250 times. Virginia Roberts is documented 31 times. Jean-Luc Brunel, 30 times. Bill Clinton, 25 times. Chris Tucker, 15 times. Alan Dershowitz, 12 times. Kevin Spacey, 11 times. Larry Summers, 5 times. Prince Andrew, documented in separate records. Donald Trump, once in these logs, with additional flights on other Epstein aircraft documented elsewhere.

Every one of those flights required a manifest. Every manifest required names. Every name is now in the public record. And for every famous name on those manifests, there are dozens of names that are not famous — names of girls who were fifteen, sixteen, seventeen, who flew from Palm Beach to the island or from New York to Paris on private jets alongside men old enough to be their grandfathers, who ate from the same kitchen, swam in the same pool, and returned to the same massage rooms that were documented in the crime scene photographs four blocks from the Frick Collection.

Shall I Bring Her to Temple

On May 10, 2008, Ghislaine Maxwell sent Jeffrey Epstein a two-word question: *Shall I bring her to temple?*

Epstein's reply: yes.

The Zen Studies Society is one of the oldest Buddhist institutions in the Western hemisphere. Founded in 1956, it operates the 1,400-acre Dai Bosatsu Zendo retreat in the Catskill Mountains of New York. The EFTA corpus references it in connection with what has been called the "Shimano Problem" — Eido Shimano, the founder and longtime abbot, resigned after decades of documented sexual misconduct. A spiritual leader using institutional authority to exploit followers. The pattern was familiar. The venue was new.

Maxwell's "temple" reference is not metaphorical. The ZSS connection runs through Nadia Marcinkova — the Slovakian woman the FBI described as having been purchased from her parents, the woman Epstein called "Global Girl," the woman whose connection to ZSS included \$1 asset transfers using the same nominal-value structure as the Wexner mansion transfer. The financial architecture of the Epstein network — shell companies, trusts, offshore vehicles — was replicated through religious institutions, which offer a legal framework for receiving assets at nominal valuations without triggering standard reporting requirements.

The pattern appears again at Zorro Ranch in New Mexico, which was being transitioned for use as a Christian retreat. A Buddhist temple in the Catskills. A Christian retreat in the desert. Different religions, same function: opacity. The ability to move assets from one designation to another without anyone asking what the assets were worth or where they came from.

Epstein's Buddhist references run through his communications like a thread that only becomes visible when you read everything: "I think you meant Buddha" to Summers the day before his arrest. "What is the sound of one hand clapping" to Bannon after the sealed documents article. The Benedictine monastery cloister he emailed about in February 2019. The "Tibet temple in NJ, 3 hours of praying" that a woman in his orbit visited in 2012. These are not the idle musings of an intellectual dilettante. They are references to the infrastructure — the temples, the retreats, the religious organizations — through which parts of his empire were built and through which parts of his assets were moved.

The houses watched. The cameras recorded. The temples received. The ranch converted. And the island — where the construction never stopped and the flights never stopped and the girls never stopped coming — was the center of it all. Seventy-two acres in the Caribbean, connected by private jet to Manhattan and Palm Beach and Paris and Novosibirsk, maintained by a staff that sent daily photographs of pool tiles and dock repairs while the machine that employed them consumed children.

CHAPTER SIX

The Machine

The machine had rules. They were never written down — you will not find them in any of the 3.5 million documents — but they emerge from the evidence with the clarity of a blueprint once you have read enough of it. Rule one: find the vulnerable. Rule two: offer what they need. Rule three: escalate gradually. Rule four: make them complicit. Rule five: discard or recruit.

The vulnerability could be anything. A dead father. Food stamps. A mother's surgery in Siberia. A modeling career that wasn't going anywhere. A desire to be seen by someone powerful. A need for money that was just urgent enough to override the instinct that said something was wrong. The machine was not particular about the nature of the vulnerability. It was particular about its depth.

Ghislaine Maxwell understood this better than anyone. The prosecution memorandum that describes her technique reads like a manual for social engineering: approach the girl in a place where she feels safe. Bring a prop — a dog, a smile, a story about scholarships. Get the phone number. Have someone from the office call. Invite her to a house. Serve tea by the pool. Use the words *mentor* and *opportunity* and *talent*. Never use the words that describe what is actually about to happen.

Maxwell did this hundreds of times. She had 1,040 entries in the flight logs. She appeared in 127 photographs in the facial recognition database. She was present in the email corpus from the earliest entries through 2019 — managing staff, coordinating travel, evaluating recruits, and handling the logistics of an operation that spanned six countries and three decades. In May 2008, she asked Epstein if she should "bring her to temple." In January 2015, she drafted public statements about the Prince Andrew allegations. In the victim diary, she is the person who covered the girl's face during the forced medical procedure — "Ghislaine said to push all the pain away" — and the person the girl reached for when the pain became unbearable: "when I need Ghislaine she is working." Present for the abuse. Absent for the aftermath. The perfect handler.

The Escalation Protocol

Jennifer Araoz's testimony — filed with the Southern District of New York and preserved in the EFTA corpus — describes the escalation with the precision of someone who has replayed it in her mind thousands of times.

The first visit: talking. Just talking. About her dreams, her school, her father's death. Three hundred dollars when she left. The second visit: more talking, and a gift — a digital camera. The third visit: a request for a massage. He needed to see her body, he said, if he was going to help her break into modeling. She took off her top. The fourth visit: during the massage, he flipped over and touched himself. The fifth, the sixth, the seventh — each one a small increment past the boundary that had been crossed the time before, each one accompanied by cash, each one making the next one feel less like a violation and more like a transaction she had already agreed to.

"The last day I went to his house was during the fall of my sophomore year," she wrote. "This time, when I was giving him the massage, he told me to take off my underwear and get on top of him. When I said no, he got more aggressive, held me tightly and raped me."

She was fifteen. She never went back. She quit her performing arts school because it was four blocks from his house. She transferred to a school in Queens. She dropped out. The career she had dreamed about — the one the stranger outside her school had promised Jeffrey Epstein could help with — died in a room on the Upper East Side, on a massage table, next to a bottle of oil.

This was not an isolated incident. It was a protocol. The SDNY prosecution memorandum describes the identical pattern across dozens of victims: "Victims were initially recruited to provide 'massages' to Epstein, which would be performed nude or partially nude, would become increasingly sexual in nature, and would typically include one or more sex acts, including groping and direct or indirect contact with victims' genitals. Epstein paid his victims hundreds of dollars in cash for each separate encounter." The language is clinical because it is legal. The reality was not clinical. The reality was a fifteen-year-old girl being raped on a table while cameras recorded it from angles she didn't know existed.

The Pyramid

The most efficient feature of the machine was its ability to turn victims into recruiters. "Epstein actively encouraged certain of his victims to recruit additional girls to be similarly sexually abused," the SDNY prosecution memorandum states. "He incentivized his victims to become

recruiters by paying these victim-recruiters hundreds of dollars for each additional girl they brought to him."

This is the architecture of a pyramid scheme applied to child sexual abuse. The original victims — the girls who came for massages and left with cash — were offered a way to make more money without being touched: find other girls. Bring them to the house. Collect a fee for each one. The transaction was simple. The moral calculus was devastating. A sixteen-year-old who had been abused could either continue being abused or start bringing other sixteen-year-olds to be abused in her place. Many chose the second option. Not because they were evil, but because the system was designed to make that choice feel like the only way out.

Haley Robson was one of the recruiters. She is on Brad Edwards' list of thirty-two victims. She is also the woman Epstein identified in his own defense: "Saige was brought to the house by Haley a stripper who told both her and others to lie about their age." Robson was a victim who became a perpetrator. The machine consumed her and then used her to consume others. No quarter for that choice. But understanding that the choice was engineered — that the machine was specifically designed to produce it — is necessary to understanding how the machine worked.

The girl who wrote the diary understood this too. She wrote about "the other girls" — "well some are nice, but 3 I hate!" She hated three of them. Not the men who raped her. The other girls. Because the other girls were the ones she could see, the ones at her level, the ones whose complicity was visible in a way that the complicity of senators and CEOs and former presidents was not. The machine turned its victims against each other. That was the final rule: make sure the people at the bottom blame each other, not the people at the top.

Candidates.docx

By 2017, the international arm of the recruitment operation had achieved a level of professionalization that would be impressive if it were not horrifying.

An email arrived in Jeffrey Epstein's inbox with an attachment called Candidates.docx. The word *candidates* — as if these were applicants for a management training program. The document listed women by their physical descriptions, their ages, their travel availability, and their willingness to come to Paris. One of them, the recruiter noted, "confessed she is actually 19 (as opposed to 21 which was stated in her CV), she said she was afraid she won't be taken seriously." Another was "flying to Novosibirsk tonight." Another had been in a "Miss Russia contest."

The recruiter asked the question that could serve as the epitaph for the entire operation: "How many can we bring to Paris this time?"

How many. Not who. Not whether. How many. The question of a logistics coordinator, not a human being. The girls were cargo, denominated in units, to be transported from Siberia to Paris in quantities determined by the client's appetite and the season's availability.

And the pipeline ran all the way to the end. On January 3, 2019 — six months before the arrest — Masha Drokova emailed Epstein: "We pick 12 people for the start. Say 6 guys, 6 girls. For example Samantha, Katya, Jay, Neil and I'll show you more candidates. Gathering them every 3 months or more often." A quarterly recruitment schedule. Twelve people at a time. Six and six. Names already selected. Structure already in place. The machine was still running at full capacity, scheduling its next intake, selecting its next candidates, six months before the FBI would assemble the arrest team over the Fourth of July weekend.

On April 4, 2019 — three months before the arrest — an unidentified woman emailed Epstein: "Jeffrey what kind of massage do you like? ;)" followed by: "Why is Jeffrey so nice with me :)))) usually people are not nice!" She did not understand what she was walking into. The machine did not require her to understand. It only required her to arrive.

Chapter placeholder — writing in progress

Chapter placeholder — writing in progress

Chapter placeholder — writing in progress

Chapter placeholder — writing in progress

APPENDICES

Appendix A — Outstanding FOIA Requests

The Obsidian Watch Group has filed 20 FOIA requests targeting records no known party has sought. These are documented separately in `OUTSTANDING_FOIA_REQUESTS.md` in the public repository. Printable letters for each request are available in the `FOIA_Letters/` directory.

Appendix B — FBI Case Numbers

Case Number	Description	Status
31E-MM-108062	Original Miami sex trafficking investigation	Closed (NPA)
50D-NY-3027571	SDNY main trafficking investigation	Pending Inactive
90A-NY-3151227	MCC death investigation	Closed 12/5/2022
FOIPA 1142669	Epstein's own FOIA request for FBI files (2010)	Processed

Appendix C — Key EFTA Bates Ranges

Bates Range	Content
EFTA00000001-00000600+	Crime scene photographs — 9 E 71st Street
EFTA00039227-00040941	BOP/MCC records and procedures
EFTA00062510	Cellmate testimony — 'above my pay grade'
EFTA00065479	Victim affidavit — blackmail operation
EFTA00076059-60	'Belongs to intelligence' reporting
EFTA00077309	OPR report — hidden cameras confirmed
EFTA00126232-34	MCC camera recording failures
EFTA00142908	FBI NVR seizure after death
EFTA00163433-34	FBI death investigation closure memo
EFTA00163534-35	Dershowitz FBI FD-302 proffers
EFTA00173255-58	FOIA case 1142669 — Epstein's own request
EFTA00748556	'Trash all deleted emails please'
EFTA01021714	Barak-Epstein Carbyne/Reporty warrants

Bates Range	Content
EFTA01296860	Hidden cameras — blackmail filing
EFTA01359808	Deutsche Bank FEDWIRE to Sberbank
EFTA01648796-807	FBI M365 'Epstein Photos' sharing (Jul 2025)
EFTA01821395-96	Mandelson 'mildly threaten' Chancellor
EFTA02730265	Gates-Nikolic separation agreement
EFTA02730468	SECRET//NOFORN — FBI 1996 FD-71 reference
EFTA02730486/741	FBI case summary — case still open
EFTA02730996	Apollo/Black Dechert investigation memo
EFTA02731039	SDNY Prosecution Memorandum
EFTA02731069	Corporate prosecution analysis
EFTA02731082	Co-conspirator investigation memo
EFTA02731168	Maxwell prosecution memorandum
EFTA02731200	Assistant prosecution memo (1994 timeline)
EFTA02731226	Maxwell superseding indictment memo
EFTA02731254-72	Victim trauma journal (2012)
EFTA02731341	'The Jailer' poem
EFTA02731361	Forced procedure — Israeli doctor
EFTA02731393-95	Second miscarriage
EFTA02731420-71	Victim diary — names, abuse, pregnancy
EFTA02731433-34	FUNERAL written five times

BY THE NUMBERS

Metric	Value
Investigation hours	688+
OSINT searches	500+ across 40 countries
Items read line by line	3,482,240+
Emails read	2,119,000+
Documents read (full text)	1,333,541
iMessages read	4,509
Photos analyzed	18,308
Flights analyzed	4,292
People identified (facial rec)	473
Flagged items with notes	98,185+ (emails) + 1,024,682+ (documents)
Reading notes on disk	759 MB
Source files analyzed	60 (12,500+ lines)
FOIA requests filed	20
EFTA bates numbers cited	100+
Named individuals documented	85+
Corporate entities traced	56+
Verified findings (Tier 1)	16 primary
Active investigation threads	24
Compute infrastructure	1,121-core cluster + 3-node Proxmox

For the Record

This investigation was conducted by the Obsidian Watch Group under Client 0001317. Lead Investigator: Jay Puckett. The investigation began as a public interest research project and expanded as the scope of the evidence became clear.

The investigator is a United States military veteran who served in Afghanistan. He undertook this work because the political pressures that protected Jeffrey Epstein are the same pressures that sent his friends to wars from which they did not return. Their children will never meet their fathers. This investigation is conducted in their memory and for the children who could still fall to this machine.

Every document cited in this report is a public record released by the United States Department of Justice. Every email is from the EFTA corpus archived at [jmail.world](https://www.jmail.world/). Every finding can be independently verified. This is not speculation. This is not conspiracy theory. This is the documentary record of what happened, who did it, and who looked away.

Contact: obsidianinvestigations@pm.me

Repository: github.com/jpuckett11/ObsidianGroup_Epstein-Client0001317_pub

GPG: 9267A71E3F0A4EED2F973F9BA3E252F24635CC6C

"I am too young and he is too old! Why is no one doing anything! I dont understand! I dont want this!"

— A child. EFTA02731471.